



GOVERNANCE DOCUMENT

Membership Fees, Funds and Payments Policy

International Society of Equity Analysts

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This document forms part of the official governance framework of the International Society of Equity Analysts (ISEA) and should be read together with the related documents listed above.

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1. Purpose and Scope

- 1.1** This Membership Fees, Refunds and Payments Policy ("Policy") establishes the principles, rules and procedures governing the imposition, payment, administration and refund of fees payable to the International Society of Equity Analysts ("ISEA") in connection with individual membership.
- 1.2** This Policy applies to all fees payable by or in respect of applicants for membership, Student Members, Associate Members, Members, Fellows, and any other category of individual membership recognised by ISEA from time to time.
- 1.3** This Policy governs, without limitation:
- (a) application fees;
 - (b) renewal and subscription fees;
 - (c) assessment, examination and admission fees;
 - (d) reinstatement and reactivation fees;
 - (e) late payment charges and administrative fees;
 - (f) refunds of any fee described above; and
 - (g) the payment methods, currencies and processes by which such fees are collected, recorded and reconciled.
- 1.4** This Policy does not apply to fees, sponsorships or charges payable under separate commercial agreements between ISEA and corporate, academic or institutional partners, which are governed by the ISEA Organisational Partnerships Framework.
- 1.5** This Policy forms part of ISEA's governance framework and shall be read together with the Charter, the Membership Regulations, the Membership Policy and any other applicable ISEA governance document.

2. Authority and Governance

- 2.1** This Policy is made pursuant to the authority of the Governing Council of ISEA ("Governing Council") under the Charter of the International Society of Equity Analysts ("Charter").
- 2.2** The Governing Council has ultimate responsibility for the approval, amendment and oversight of this Policy.
- 2.3** The Governing Council delegates day-to-day administration of this Policy to the Membership and Chapters Committee, which may in turn delegate operational functions to ISEA staff, finance personnel or authorised third-party payment processors, subject to appropriate oversight and reporting.
- 2.4** Nothing in this Policy limits the Governing Council's ability to approve exceptions, waivers or alternative arrangements in individual cases where it considers this necessary to uphold the objects of ISEA or to avoid unfairness or hardship.

3. Definitions

- 3.1** In this Policy, unless the context otherwise requires:
- (a) **"Administrative Error"** means an error made by ISEA, its staff, agents or authorised payment processors in the calculation, processing, recording or communication of a fee, including but not limited to incorrect billing, incorrect fee category applied, or a system or processing malfunction attributable to ISEA;
 - (b) **"Applicant"** means a person who has submitted an application for membership, renewal, advancement or reinstatement and in respect of whom a fee is or may become payable;
 - (c) **"Business Day"** means a day other than a Saturday, Sunday or public holiday in the jurisdiction in which ISEA's principal administrative office is located;

- (d) **"Duplicate Payment"** means a payment made in excess of the amount properly payable, including where the same fee has been charged or paid more than once;
- (e) **"Fee"** means any amount payable to ISEA under this Policy, including application fees, renewal fees, assessment fees and administrative charges;
- (f) **"Fee Schedule"** means the current schedule of Fees published by ISEA in accordance with Section 9 of this Policy;
- (g) **"Membership Regulations"** means the ISEA Membership Regulations as amended from time to time;
- (h) **"Payment Method"** means any method by which a Fee may be paid to ISEA in accordance with Section 10 of this Policy;
- (i) **"Refund"** means the return, in whole or in part, of a Fee previously paid to ISEA;
- (j) **"Required Service"** means a specific membership-related service, assessment, benefit or entitlement for which a Fee has been charged;
- (k) **"Sponsoring Organisation"** means an employer, academic institution or other third party that pays or undertakes to pay a Fee on behalf of a member or applicant.

4. Relationship with Other Governance Documents

- 4.1** This Policy operates alongside, and does not replace, the Membership Regulations, which establish the binding rules and procedures governing membership generally.
- 4.2** Where any inconsistency exists between this Policy and the Charter, the Charter prevails to the extent of the inconsistency.
- 4.3** Where any inconsistency exists between this Policy and the Membership Regulations in relation to fees, payments or refunds specifically, this Policy prevails to the extent of the inconsistency, unless the Governing Council determines otherwise.
- 4.4** This Policy should be read together with the Member Admission Framework, the Fellowship Framework and the Continuing Professional Development Policy, each of which may reference fees payable under this Policy.

5. Guiding Principles

- 5.1** ISEA administers fees, payments and refunds in accordance with the following principles:
 - (a) **Transparency** — fees and refund criteria shall be clearly communicated to applicants and members;
 - (b) **Consistency** — comparable circumstances shall be treated in a comparable manner;
 - (c) **Fairness** — decisions shall have regard to the individual circumstances of the person concerned;
 - (d) **Financial Sustainability** — fees shall be set at a level that supports ISEA's ongoing operations and objects;
 - (e) **Proportionality** — administrative charges and deductions shall be proportionate to the cost and effort involved;
 - (f) **Accountability** — decisions relating to fees and refunds shall be properly recorded and, where applicable, subject to review.

6. Roles and Responsibilities

- 6.1** This Section summarises the principal roles and responsibilities for the administration of this Policy. It is descriptive only and does not limit the delegations described elsewhere in this Policy.

Governing Council

- 6.2** The Governing Council is responsible for approving this Policy, setting the overall Fee structure, and considering Refund matters escalated to it in accordance with Section 22.

Membership and Chapters Committee

6.3 The Membership and Chapters Committee is responsible for the day-to-day administration of this Policy, including oversight of Fee collection, assessment of Refund requests, and reporting to the Governing Council under Section 33.

ISEA Finance Function

6.4 ISEA's finance personnel are responsible for invoicing, payment processing, reconciliation, record-keeping and the processing of approved Refunds in accordance with this Policy.

Members and Applicants

6.5 Members and applicants are responsible for ensuring that accurate payment details are provided to ISEA, that Fees are paid by the applicable due date, and that any request for a Refund is submitted in accordance with Section 21.

7. Membership Fee Structure

7.1 ISEA imposes fees in respect of the membership classes and services described in the Membership Regulations, including Student Membership, Associate Membership, Member status and Fellowship.

7.2 The applicable fee structure may distinguish between, without limitation:

- (a) application fees, payable upon submission of an application for membership, advancement or reinstatement;
- (b) annual renewal or subscription fees, payable to maintain current membership;
- (c) assessment fees, payable in connection with the Equity Research Assessment, examinations or other admission requirements;
- (d) late payment and reinstatement charges; and
- (e) fees for optional services, including certificates, verifications and expedited processing.

Fee Categories by Membership Class

7.3 Different fees may apply to Student Members, Associate Members, Members and Fellows, having regard to the differing rights, obligations and level of professional recognition associated with each membership class.

7.4 Student Members shall generally be subject to a reduced fee structure in recognition of their status as students, subject to verification of continued eligibility in accordance with the Membership Regulations.

Application Fees

7.5 An application fee is payable at the time an application for membership, advancement or reinstatement is submitted, unless ISEA determines otherwise in a particular case.

7.6 Payment of an application fee does not guarantee admission, advancement or reinstatement, and is not refundable solely on the basis that an application is unsuccessful, except as provided in Section 19 of this Policy.

Renewal Fees

7.7 A renewal fee is payable by a member seeking to maintain current membership for the following membership period, in accordance with the renewal requirements established under the Membership Regulations.

7.8 Failure to pay a renewal fee by the applicable due date may result in suspension or termination of membership in accordance with Section 13 of this Policy and the Membership Regulations.

8. Illustrative Fee Schedule

8.1 The table below is provided for illustrative purposes only, to demonstrate the general structure of Fees referred to in this Policy. It does not constitute the current, binding Fee Schedule, which is published and updated separately in accordance with Section 9.

Fee Type	Applicable To	Timing
Application Fee	All applicants	At submission of application
Annual Renewal Fee - Student Member	Student Members	Annually, on renewal date
Annual Renewal Fee - Associate Member	Associate Members	Annually, on renewal date
Annual Renewal Fee - Member	Members	Annually, on renewal date
Annual Renewal Fee - Fellow	Fellows	Annually, on renewal date
Equity Research Assessment Fee	Applicants for Member status	At enrolment in assessment
Fellowship Assessment Fee	Applicants for Fellowship	At submission of Fellowship application
Late Payment Charge	Members with overdue Fees	On expiry of grace period
Reinstatement Fee	Former members seeking reinstatement	At submission of reinstatement request

Fee Type	Applicable To	Timing
Certificate / Verification Fee	Members requesting documentation	At time of request

8.2 Current Fee amounts are published in the Fee Schedule available on ISEA's official website, and prevail over any illustrative figures referenced elsewhere.

9. Fee Setting, Review and Publication

9.1 The Governing Council shall determine the amount of each Fee, having regard to ISEA's operating costs, market conditions, comparable professional bodies and the financial sustainability of ISEA.

9.2 Fees shall be reviewed by the Governing Council not less than once every financial year, and may be amended at any time where the Governing Council considers this necessary.

9.3 Current Fees shall be published on ISEA's official website and made available to applicants and members upon request.

9.4 Any amendment to a Fee shall not apply retrospectively to a Fee already paid, but shall apply to Fees becoming payable on or after the effective date of the amendment.

9.5 Where a Fee amendment is adopted, ISEA shall provide reasonable notice to members prior to the amended Fee taking effect wherever practicable.

10. Payment Methods and Currency

10.1 Fees may be paid by any Payment Method made available by ISEA from time to time, which may include:

- (a) credit card or debit card payment;
- (b) electronic funds transfer or bank transfer;
- (c) approved third-party online payment platforms;
- (d) direct debit or recurring payment authorisation; and
- (e) such other Payment Method as ISEA may approve.

10.2 All Fees are payable in the currency specified by ISEA at the time of invoicing, which will ordinarily be United States dollars unless otherwise stated.

10.3 Where a member elects to pay in a currency other than the currency specified by ISEA, any currency conversion, foreign transaction charge or bank fee arising from that election is the responsibility of the member.

10.4 ISEA is not responsible for exchange rate fluctuations between the date an invoice is issued and the date payment is received.

11. Payment Obligations and Due Dates

11.1 A member's obligation to pay applicable Fees continues regardless of whether the member actively participates in ISEA activities, uses membership benefits, or intends to apply for another membership class.

11.2 Application fees are due and payable at the time an application is submitted, unless ISEA specifies an alternative arrangement.

11.3 Renewal fees are due and payable by the renewal date determined in accordance with the Membership Regulations, whether that date is a common membership renewal date, an anniversary-based renewal date, or such other date as the Governing Council may establish.

- 11.4** ISEA may issue reminders in advance of a payment due date as a courtesy, but the absence of a reminder does not relieve a member of the obligation to pay applicable Fees by the due date.

12. Invoicing, Receipts and Tax Documentation

- 12.1** ISEA shall issue an invoice or payment request to a member or applicant prior to, or at the time of, a Fee becoming payable, specifying the amount, currency and due date.
- 12.2** Upon receipt of payment, ISEA shall issue a receipt or payment confirmation to the payer, which shall serve as evidence of payment for the member's records.
- 12.3** Where required by applicable law, ISEA shall issue tax invoices or equivalent documentation reflecting any goods and services tax, value-added tax or similar levy applicable to the Fee.
- 12.4** Members are responsible for retaining copies of invoices and receipts for their own taxation, reimbursement or record-keeping purposes.

13. Consequences of Non-Payment

- 13.1** Failure to pay an applicable Fee by the relevant due date may result in one or more of the following consequences, as determined by ISEA having regard to the circumstances:
- (a) issuance of a payment reminder or overdue notice;
 - (b) imposition of a late payment charge in accordance with the published Fee Schedule;
 - (c) suspension of membership rights, benefits and use of post-nominal designations;
 - (d) removal from the Membership Register;
 - (e) termination of membership in accordance with the Membership Regulations; and
 - (f) referral of the outstanding amount for debt recovery, where ISEA considers this appropriate.
- 13.2** A member whose membership has been suspended or terminated for non-payment may apply for reinstatement in accordance with the Membership Regulations, which may require payment of outstanding Fees together with any applicable reinstatement charge.
- 13.3** ISEA may, in its discretion, grant a reasonable grace period or payment plan to a member experiencing genuine payment difficulty, having regard to the principles in Section 5 of this Policy and the fee waiver provisions in Section 17.

14. Failed, Declined and Dishonoured Payments

- 14.1** Where a payment is declined, dishonoured, reversed or otherwise fails to be received by ISEA in cleared funds, the underlying Fee shall be treated as unpaid until such time as payment is successfully received.
- 14.2** ISEA may charge a reasonable administrative fee to recover costs directly associated with a declined or dishonoured payment, including bank dishonour fees passed on by ISEA's financial institution.
- 14.3** Repeated failed payment attempts in respect of a recurring or automatic payment arrangement may result in ISEA suspending or cancelling that arrangement and requiring the member to arrange payment by an alternative Payment Method.
- 14.4** Nothing in this Section limits ISEA's rights under Section 13 in respect of non-payment.

15. Recurring and Automatic Payments

- 15.1** ISEA may offer members the option of authorising recurring or automatic payment of renewal Fees by direct debit, credit card or other approved Payment Method.

- 15.2 A member who authorises a recurring payment arrangement remains responsible for ensuring that valid payment details are maintained and that sufficient funds or credit are available on the applicable due date.
- 15.3 A member may cancel a recurring payment authorisation at any time by providing reasonable notice to ISEA, provided that cancellation does not relieve the member of any Fee obligation that has already accrued.
- 15.4 ISEA shall provide reasonable advance notice to a member before processing a recurring payment, where practicable, to allow the member an opportunity to review or cancel the arrangement.

16. Corporate, Group and Sponsored Memberships

- 16.1 Where an individual's membership Fees are paid or sponsored by a Sponsoring Organisation, the individual member remains personally responsible for compliance with this Policy and the Membership Regulations.
- 16.2 ISEA may, at its discretion, issue invoices directly to a Sponsoring Organisation, provided that appropriate authorisation and payment arrangements have been established with ISEA in advance.
- 16.3 Where a Sponsoring Organisation fails to pay a Fee on behalf of a member, the member remains liable for that Fee and is subject to the consequences described in Section 13 in the same manner as if the member had paid directly.
- 16.4 Refunds in respect of sponsored or corporately-paid Fees shall, unless ISEA determines otherwise, be made to the party that made the original payment.

17. Fee Waivers, Concessions and Financial Hardship

- 17.1 The Governing Council may establish, from time to time, categories of Fee concession, discount or waiver, which may include concessions for Student Members, early-career professionals, members in regions with lower relative income levels, or members experiencing genuine financial hardship.
- 17.2 A member seeking a Fee waiver or concession on the basis of financial hardship must submit a written request to ISEA, together with such supporting information as ISEA may reasonably require.
- 17.3 ISEA shall assess a hardship request having regard to the member's individual circumstances, the availability of concession funding, and the principles set out in Section 5 of this Policy.
- 17.4 A decision to grant or refuse a Fee waiver or concession is at ISEA's discretion and does not create a precedent binding ISEA in respect of any other member or any future application by the same member.
- 17.5 Information provided in support of a hardship request shall be treated confidentially in accordance with the ISEA Privacy Policy and Section 29 of this Policy.

18. General Principle of Non-Refundability

- 18.1 Membership Fees are generally **non-refundable** once processing of the relevant application, renewal, assessment or service has commenced.
- 18.2 This general principle reflects the fact that ISEA incurs administrative, assessment and operational costs upon commencement of processing, irrespective of the ultimate outcome of an application or the member's subsequent decisions.

18.3 The general principle of non-refundability in this Section is subject to the specific circumstances described in Section 19, in which ISEA may, in its discretion, consider a Refund.

18.4 Nothing in this Section obliges ISEA to grant a Refund in any circumstance; a Refund shall only be made where ISEA is satisfied, following assessment under Section 22, that a Refund is appropriate.

19. Circumstances in Which a Refund May Be Considered

19.1 ISEA may consider a Refund, in whole or in part, where one or more of the following circumstances is established to ISEA's reasonable satisfaction:

- (a) an **Administrative Error** occurred;
- (b) a **Duplicate Payment** was made;
- (c) **exceptional circumstances** exist;
- (d) a **Required Service** cannot be provided by ISEA; or
- (e) another basis approved by ISEA exists.

Administrative Error

19.2 Where ISEA identifies, or a member demonstrates, that a Fee was charged, calculated or processed incorrectly as a result of an Administrative Error, ISEA shall correct the error and, where an overpayment resulted, refund the excess amount.

19.3 A Refund arising from Administrative Error shall ordinarily be made in full in respect of the amount overcharged, without deduction of any administrative charge referred to in Section 23.

Duplicate Payment

19.4 Where a member establishes that the same Fee has been paid more than once, whether due to a processing error, a repeated payment submission, or any other cause, ISEA shall refund the duplicate amount.

19.5 A member who becomes aware of a Duplicate Payment should notify ISEA as soon as reasonably practicable to facilitate prompt investigation and Refund.

Exceptional Circumstances

19.6 ISEA may consider a Refund where exceptional circumstances exist that, in ISEA's reasonable opinion, make it unfair or unreasonable to retain the Fee. Exceptional circumstances may include, without limitation:

- (a) serious illness, injury or bereavement affecting the applicant or a member of their immediate family;
- (b) circumstances beyond the applicant's control that prevented participation in an assessment or service for which the Fee was paid;
- (c) natural disaster, civil unrest or other significant disruption affecting the applicant; or
- (d) such other circumstances as ISEA, in its discretion, considers exceptional.

19.7 An applicant relying on exceptional circumstances must provide ISEA with reasonable supporting evidence, which ISEA shall treat confidentially.

Inability to Provide a Required Service

19.8 Where ISEA is unable to provide a Required Service for which a Fee has been paid, including due to cancellation, discontinuation or unavailability of the relevant service, ISEA shall refund the Fee attributable to that service, or offer an alternative service or credit, at the member's election where reasonably practicable.

Other Basis Approved by ISEA

19.9 The Governing Council, or a person or body to whom the Governing Council has delegated authority under Section 22, may approve a Refund on any other basis not otherwise described in

this Section, where it considers this appropriate having regard to the guiding principles in Section 5.

20. Circumstances in Which Refunds Will Not Be Granted

20.1 Except as provided in Section 19, a Refund will not ordinarily be granted in the following circumstances:

- (a) the applicant simply changes their mind after processing has commenced;
- (b) an application is refused, or an applicant does not meet eligibility or assessment requirements, where the assessment or eligibility determination has already been undertaken;
- (c) a member fails to use membership benefits, attend an event, or complete an assessment for which they were eligible and able to participate;
- (d) a member's employment, personal or professional circumstances change after payment, other than as described under exceptional circumstances in Section 19;
- (e) membership is suspended, terminated or not renewed as a result of disciplinary action or a breach of ISEA's governance requirements; or
- (f) the request for a Refund is made outside the timeframe specified in Section 21.

20.2 ISEA's decision that a circumstance falls within this Section rather than Section 19 is subject to the review and complaints mechanisms described in Sections 32 and 34.

21. Refund Application Process

21.1 A member or applicant seeking a Refund must submit a written request to ISEA, using the form or process specified by ISEA from time to time, within **twelve (12) months** of the date the relevant Fee was paid, unless ISEA agrees to extend this timeframe in exceptional circumstances.

21.2 A Refund request must include, at a minimum:

- (a) the requester's name and membership number, if applicable;
- (b) the date and amount of the Fee paid;
- (c) the ground on which a Refund is sought, by reference to Section 19; and
- (d) any supporting evidence relevant to that ground.

21.3 ISEA may request further information reasonably necessary to assess a Refund request, and may decline to proceed with the assessment until such information is provided.

21.4 ISEA shall acknowledge receipt of a Refund request within a reasonable time, and in any event within **ten (10) Business Days**.

22. Assessment, Decision-Making and Delegation of Authority

22.1 Refund requests shall be assessed by ISEA staff with delegated authority from the Membership and Chapters Committee, having regard to the circumstances described in Section 19, the evidence provided, and the principles in Section 5.

22.2 The Membership and Chapters Committee may establish internal delegations specifying the value of Refund that may be approved at each level of authority, with Refunds above a specified threshold requiring approval by the Membership and Chapters Committee or the Governing Council.

22.3 A decision on a Refund request shall be communicated to the requester in writing, including the outcome and, where the request is declined in whole or in part, the reasons for that decision.

22.4 ISEA shall endeavour to determine a Refund request within **twenty (20) Business Days** of receiving all information reasonably required to assess the request, recognising that more complex requests may require additional time.

- 22.5** A person who is dissatisfied with a decision on a Refund request may seek review of that decision in accordance with Section 32.

23. Refund Amounts, Deductions and Administrative Charges

- 23.1** Where a Refund is approved, the amount refunded shall be calculated by reference to the Fee actually paid, less any amount properly attributable to services already provided or costs already incurred by ISEA, unless the Refund arises from Administrative Error or Duplicate Payment under Section 19.
- 23.2** ISEA may deduct a reasonable administrative charge from an approved Refund to reflect the processing, banking and administrative costs associated with the Refund, except where the Refund arises from Administrative Error or Duplicate Payment.
- 23.3** Any third-party transaction fee, currency conversion fee or payment processor charge incurred in connection with the original payment is not refundable by ISEA, except where such a fee arose directly from an Administrative Error.
- 23.4** Where a Fee covered more than one service or entitlement, and only part of that Fee is the subject of an approved Refund, ISEA shall calculate a proportionate Refund by reference to the value of the unprovided portion.

24. Timeframes for Processing Refunds

- 24.1** Once a Refund has been approved, ISEA shall process payment of the Refund within **twenty (20) Business Days**, subject to the payment processing timeframes of the relevant financial institution or payment processor.
- 24.2** ISEA is not responsible for delays in a Refund reaching a member's account that are caused by the member's bank, card issuer or payment processor, and not by ISEA.
- 24.3** Where a Refund cannot be processed within the timeframe specified in this Section due to circumstances beyond ISEA's reasonable control, ISEA shall notify the requester of the delay and the expected revised timeframe.

25. Method and Currency of Refund Payments

- 25.1** A Refund shall ordinarily be made using the same Payment Method and to the same payment source used for the original payment, unless this is not reasonably practicable, in which case ISEA may arrange an alternative method in consultation with the requester.
- 25.2** A Refund shall ordinarily be made in the same currency in which the original Fee was paid.
- 25.3** ISEA is not responsible for any difference between the amount originally paid and the amount received as a Refund that arises solely from currency exchange rate fluctuation between the date of payment and the date of Refund.

26. Special Provisions for Assessment and Examination Fees

- 26.1** This Section applies specifically to fees paid in connection with the Equity Research Assessment, examinations, or other formal assessment processes administered by ISEA under the Member Admission Framework.
- 26.2** Where an applicant withdraws from a scheduled assessment more than **thirty (30) days** before the scheduled date, ISEA may, at its discretion, permit the applicant to transfer the assessment fee to a future assessment sitting rather than requiring a Refund request.
- 26.3** Where an applicant withdraws from a scheduled assessment less than thirty days before the scheduled date, the assessment fee is non-refundable except where the circumstances fall within Section 19.

- 26.4** Where ISEA cancels or reschedules a scheduled assessment for reasons within ISEA's control, affected applicants shall be offered, at their election, a transfer to the next available sitting at no additional charge, or a full Refund of the assessment fee.
- 26.5** A fee paid for re-marking, review of assessment results, or a supplementary oral defence is separate from the original assessment fee and is subject to its own refund treatment as specified by ISEA at the time such a service is offered.

27. Special Provisions for Fellowship and CPD-Related Fees

- 27.1** This Section applies specifically to fees paid in connection with Fellowship admission and Continuing Professional Development ("CPD") activities administered or endorsed by ISEA.
- 27.2** Fellowship application fees are subject to the general principle of non-refundability in Section 18, and may only be refunded in accordance with Section 19.
- 27.3** Where a member pays a fee for a CPD activity delivered directly by ISEA and that activity is cancelled by ISEA, the member shall be entitled to a full Refund or a credit toward a future CPD activity, at the member's election.
- 27.4** Where a member withdraws from a CPD activity delivered directly by ISEA, any Refund shall be assessed having regard to the notice provided and the costs already incurred by ISEA in organising the activity, applying the principles in Section 23.
- 27.5** This Policy does not govern fees charged by third-party CPD providers whose activities are merely recognised or accredited by ISEA; such fees are a matter between the member and the relevant third-party provider.

28. Taxes, Levies and Statutory Charges

- 28.1** Where a Fee included an amount for goods and services tax, value-added tax or a similar statutory levy, any Refund of that Fee shall include a corresponding refund of the applicable tax component, to the extent required by applicable law.
- 28.2** Members are responsible for any taxation consequences arising in their own jurisdiction from the payment or Refund of a Fee, and should seek independent taxation advice where required.
- 28.3** ISEA shall issue a credit note or equivalent documentation in respect of an approved Refund where required by applicable tax law.

29. Record-Keeping, Privacy and Confidentiality

- 29.1** ISEA shall maintain accurate records of all Fees invoiced, payments received, and Refunds processed, for such period as is required by applicable law and ISEA's record-keeping requirements.
- 29.2** Personal and financial information provided in connection with a payment or Refund request shall be collected, used, stored and disclosed in accordance with the ISEA Privacy Policy.
- 29.3** Access to payment and Refund records shall be limited to personnel and authorised third parties who require such access to perform their duties, subject to appropriate confidentiality obligations.
- 29.4** ISEA shall not disclose a member's payment or Refund information to a third party except as required by law, as necessary to process a payment or Refund, or with the member's consent.

30. Fraud Prevention and Payment Security

- 30.1** ISEA shall take reasonable steps to protect the security of payment information, including through the use of reputable, PCI-compliant payment processors and encryption of sensitive payment data.
- 30.2** ISEA does not store full credit card or payment card numbers on its own systems, other than through secure, tokenised arrangements with authorised payment processors.
- 30.3** ISEA may decline to process a payment, or may suspend a membership pending investigation, where it reasonably suspects that a payment is fraudulent, unauthorised, or made using stolen or compromised payment details.
- 30.4** A member who suspects that their payment information has been compromised should notify ISEA immediately so that appropriate protective steps can be taken.
- 30.5** Where a payment is later found to have been made fraudulently or without proper authorisation, ISEA may reverse any membership status, benefit or Refund obtained as a result of that payment.

31. Force Majeure

- 31.1** ISEA shall not be liable for any delay or failure to perform an obligation under this Policy, including the processing of a payment or Refund, to the extent that such delay or failure arises from circumstances beyond ISEA's reasonable control, including natural disaster, pandemic, war, civil unrest, industrial action, or failure of a third-party payment system.
- 31.2** Where a force majeure event affects ISEA's ability to process payments or Refunds, ISEA shall take reasonable steps to notify affected members and to resume normal processing as soon as reasonably practicable.

32. Disputes and Complaints

- 32.1** A person who disputes the amount of a Fee, the outcome of a Refund request, or any other matter arising under this Policy may raise that dispute with ISEA in writing, setting out the basis of the dispute.
- 32.2** ISEA shall review a dispute raised under this Section through a person who was not directly involved in the original decision, where reasonably practicable.
- 32.3** Where a dispute cannot be resolved informally, the person may lodge a formal complaint in accordance with the ISEA Complaints Policy.
- 32.4** Nothing in this Policy limits a member's rights under the Membership Regulations to seek review of a decision affecting their membership status.

33. Reporting and Financial Oversight

- 33.1** The Membership and Chapters Committee shall provide the Governing Council with periodic reports on Fee revenue, outstanding amounts, and Refunds granted, at intervals determined by the Governing Council.
- 33.2** ISEA's financial records relating to Fees and Refunds shall be subject to ISEA's ordinary financial control, audit and reporting processes.
- 33.3** Any pattern of Refund requests indicating a systemic issue with the administration of Fees shall be reported to the Governing Council with recommendations for remediation.

34. Notices and Communications

- 34.1** Any notice, invoice, reminder or communication given by ISEA under this Policy may be given electronically, including by email to the address recorded in the Membership Register, unless applicable law requires otherwise.
- 34.2** A member is responsible for ensuring that ISEA holds current and accurate contact details, and ISEA is not responsible for a member's failure to receive a communication sent to an outdated address.
- 34.3** A communication sent electronically in accordance with this Section is taken to have been received on the day it is sent, unless the sender receives notice that the communication was not delivered.

35. Severability

- 35.1** If any provision of this Policy is held to be invalid, unlawful or unenforceable in any respect under applicable law, that provision shall be severed from the remainder of this Policy, which shall continue in full force and effect.

36. Delegation, Amendment and Review of this Policy

- 36.1** The Governing Council may delegate any function under this Policy to the Membership and Chapters Committee, a sub-committee, or ISEA staff, subject to such conditions as the Governing Council considers appropriate.
- 36.2** This Policy may be amended by the Governing Council from time to time, including to reflect changes in ISEA's operating costs, applicable law, or the introduction of new membership services.
- 36.3** This Policy shall be reviewed by the Governing Council not less than once every three years, or earlier if the Governing Council considers a review necessary.
- 36.4** Amendments to this Policy shall be published and communicated to members in accordance with ISEA's ordinary governance communication practices.

37. Illustrative Examples

- 37.1** This Section sets out illustrative examples of how the refund provisions of this Policy may apply in practice. These examples are provided for guidance only, do not form part of the operative provisions of this Policy, and do not limit ISEA's discretion to assess each Refund request on its own facts.

Example 1 — Administrative Error

- 37.2** A member is charged the Fellow renewal Fee in error, when the correct Fee for their membership class was the Member renewal Fee. On review, ISEA identifies the Administrative Error and refunds the difference in full, without any administrative deduction, consistent with Section 19 and Section 23.

Example 2 — Duplicate Payment

- 37.3** An applicant's payment is submitted twice due to a browser error during checkout. ISEA identifies both payments during reconciliation and refunds the duplicate transaction in full to the original payment source.

Example 3 — Exceptional Circumstances

- 37.4** An applicant enrolled in the Equity Research Assessment is hospitalised the week of the scheduled oral defence and is unable to attend. The applicant provides medical evidence. ISEA offers the applicant a transfer to the next available sitting at no additional charge, in preference to

a cash Refund, consistent with Section 26; where a transfer is not suitable to the applicant's circumstances, a Refund may be considered.

Example 4 — Required Service Cannot Be Provided

- 37.5 ISEA cancels a scheduled assessment sitting due to unavailability of assessors. Affected applicants are offered a full Refund of the assessment fee or a transfer to the next sitting at no additional charge, at their election, consistent with Section 26.

Example 5 — Change of Mind (Refund Not Granted)

- 37.6 An applicant submits a Member application, pays the application fee, and two days later decides not to proceed because they have accepted a role outside the investment profession. Processing of the application has already commenced. Consistent with Section 20, the application fee is not refunded, as this circumstance does not fall within Section 19.

Example 6 — Unsuccessful Application (Refund Not Granted)

- 37.7 An applicant completes the Equity Research Assessment but does not achieve the required standard. The assessment has been fully administered and marked. Consistent with Section 20, the assessment fee is not refunded, as an unsuccessful outcome following completed assessment is not, of itself, a ground for a Refund under Section 19.

Example 7 — Sponsored Membership

- 37.8 A member's renewal Fee is paid by their employer under a corporate sponsorship arrangement. The member resigns from their employer shortly after renewal and requests that the Fee be refunded to them personally. Consistent with Section 16, any approved Refund would be made to the Sponsoring Organisation that made the original payment, not to the individual member, unless the Sponsoring Organisation agrees otherwise in writing.

38. Interpretation

- 38.1 Headings in this Policy are for convenience only and do not affect interpretation.
- 38.2 A reference to a membership class, framework or other governance document is a reference to that class, framework or document as it exists from time to time.
- 38.3 Where any inconsistency exists between this Policy and another ISEA governance document, the order of precedence established in the Membership Regulations shall apply, subject to Section 4 of this Policy.
- 38.4 This Policy takes effect from the date approved by the Governing Council and remains in force until amended, replaced or revoked.

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